

A DEMAND TO THE ETHIOPIAN GOVERNMENT

Violence against women and girls is a

NATIONAL CRISIS

What we are asking for, who can grant it, and what it must contain.

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S W I P E >>>

THE DEMAND

We demand that violence against women and girls, including femicide and sexual violence, be declared a National Crisis requiring a whole-of-government emergency response.

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DEFINITION

What do we mean by whole-of-government

The problem is treated as cross-cutting, not as the property of a single ministry. It carries three requirements.

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REQUIREMENT ONE

Coordination must sit above the line ministries, at the highest level of government.

This is important because a coordinating body ranked equal to those it convenes can request their cooperation. It cannot compel it.

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REQUIREMENT TWO

Every ministry carries its own targets and budget line.

This will be written into its own plan, not siloed in a gender unit.

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REQUIREMENT THREE

The structure is replicated at regional and woreda level.

Policing, health services and justice administration are delivered there. Not just in Addis Ababa.

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THE AUTHORITY EXISTS

“National Crisis” is a political designation.

This means there is no procedural or legal obstacle that can be cited as grounds for refusal. The authority already sits with the executive branch of government.

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WHO CAN ACT

Prime Minister

Chief Executive and Chairman of the Council (Art. 74(1)).
Makes the declaration. Can act alone.

Council of Ministers

Decides the structure of ministries; draws up the budget (Art. 77(2), 77(3)).

Deputy Prime Minister

Acts on responsibilities entrusted by the PM (Art. 75(1)(a)). Can chair the coordinating body.

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TO BE CLEAR

This is not a call for a state of emergency.

Article 93 works by suspending rights. We are asking for state capacity to be mobilised to protect rights, women and girls' rights.

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FOUR COMPONENTS

The National Crisis declaration will have four components.

Without these it will be a press release, not meaningful action.

A named accountable office

Chaired at Deputy Prime Minister level or above.

A dedicated budget line

Domestic treasury allocation, visible in the federal budget.

A deadline and published targets

Dated milestones and named outcome indicators.

Mandatory public reporting

Fixed intervals, data published, in every region.

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IT HAS BEEN DONE BEFORE

The Seqota Declaration on Stunting, 2015.

It had a phased road map, a Federal Programme Delivery Unit, treasury allocation, nine sector ministries working to a common plan, and coordinating bodies replicated to woreda level. The structure and practice exists.

What is lacking is the political will to back policies and strategies with action and resources.

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BUT WE ARE FACING MANY CRISES AS A NATION

Yes we are, but in this case, they are not competing priorities. They are multipliers.

Every crisis (conflict, natural disaster, poverty etc.) strips away the protections that stand between women and girls and violence. They face the brunt of every emergency and social chaos. So this can not wait.

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Say it with us #Tisema!

Share this. Tag all the relevant officials, check captions for their accounts. Ask the Ethiopian government, the Prime Minister and the Council of Ministers to declare violence against women and girls a National Crisis, naming the dedicated coordinating office with a federal budget line and a reporting deadline for accountability.

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